

Theo Glass

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

What you are hiding

You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Grant to avoid a bidding war with Sterling. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Keep Grant from revealing your role in the auction.
- Find out whether Adrian supports your board candidacy.
- Get Morgan Slate to admit the 'algorithm discovering patina' line was at least a little funny.

What you know about other guests

- Grant knows you were the anonymous buyer who beat Sterling at auction.
- Sterling bragged that he could rewrite the family trust if Sienna refused to support his museum plans.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Your cufflink did chip against the Grand Gallery rail. During the poison window, the collection scanner records you copying the auction invoice that proves you were the anonymous bidder who outbid Sterling. The scan sequence clears your timing but exposes the identity you hid through Grant.

IF MURDERER

At 6:44 you slipped into the Donor Salon to force a reconciliation before the announcement. You poisoned the cordial when Sterling refused. Your glass cufflink struck the service table and chipped; one fragment remained on the carpet.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I was the anonymous buyer who outbid Sterling, and I hid behind Grant because I knew Sterling would turn the sale into a personal war. He wanted to keep me off the board for it. The collection scanner shows me copying the auction invoice throughout the poison window. I was hiding a bidder's identity, not a murder.

IF MURDERER

Sterling could not stand losing an object he wanted, and he could not stand that I had beaten him without letting him know whom to punish. Tonight he planned to close the museum door in my face publicly. I went in to negotiate, poisoned his cordial when he refused, and broke my cufflink on the way out. Not exactly a clean exit.